Zerodha Coin SIP case: interview notes

Interview questions asked

All six interviews (P1 to P6) used these questions. The numbers match the # column in each person's table, and the last column says what each question was meant to find out.

#	Question asked	Why we asked it
1	Let's draw a timeline of your SIP, from the first time you thought about investing until today. What was going on in your life when you first thought "I should start"?	Real triggers (first salary, a friend, a goal) show when to reach new investors, and what promise they bought into.
2	What else could that money have gone to: an FD, an RD, a gadget, stocks? What made the SIP win?	This is the SIP's real competition. When people stop, the money flows back to one of these.
3	When did it first feel real, the moment you thought "okay, this is working"?	Finds the activation moment. If nobody can name one, Coin never gave them a moment worth staying for.
4	Walk me through salary day. Your salary lands: where does it go over the next week, in what order?	Shows whether the SIP is paid first or fights rent and EMIs for what's left, the root of short-balance failures.
5	If one month you were ₹5,000 short, what would you cut first? Where does the SIP sit on that list?	Tells us whether a "skip one month" or "reduce for now" option would save the SIP or only delay a stop.
6	Do you think of your SIP as savings, a bill, or something else?	A bill gets paid without thinking; savings get dipped into. The framing changes how a failure feels.
7	Tell me about the last time something about your SIP surprised you, good or bad.	Lets failures come up without us naming them, unlike the survey's direct question.
8	If something went wrong: take me through that day like a film. What did you see first, and what did you do next?	Remembered steps beat opinions. Every pause in the story is friction a product can remove.
9	Who or what did you turn to: support, Google, YouTube, a friend? What did they tell you?	The discovery engine found 112 posts asking forums for help. Where people go for help is where a fix must reach them.

#	Question asked	Why we asked it
11	Which bank account is your mandate on, and do you know its limit? What would happen to your SIP if you changed bank or UPI app?	Tests the mental model behind silent failures. On Coin, a new bank needs a new mandate.
12	When you started, what number did you have in your head, for returns or for what the SIP would grow to? Where did that number come from?	Finds the expectation anchor and its source (a calculator, a friend, an ad) without suggesting returns were bad.
13	At what point would you call your SIP "not working"?	Their own line for failure. If it's about payments, that points to recovery; if it's about returns, to expectations.
14	If you stopped or paused: tell me about the day you stopped. What happened just before, and where did that money go the next month?	The order of events decides between the two problem statements, and where the money went shows the competitor.
15	Did you think about pausing or lowering the amount instead? Why or why not?	Shows whether pausing is unknown, distrusted or just hard to find.
C1	Reaction to: "Your ₹3,000 SIP is due on the 5th. Your salary usually arrives on the 7th. Move your SIP date to the 8th?"	A cheap test of whether people want a date change before anything is built.
C2	Reaction to: "This month's ₹3,000 instalment didn't go through because your autopay limit was reached. Pay it now, or skip this month and keep your SIP running."	A cheap test of what people would do right after a failure: pay now or skip.
16	What would a friend starting their first SIP on Coin need to know that nobody told you?	Surfaces set-up and expectation gaps in their own words, ready to use as in-app text.
17	Would you try an early version of a fix in a couple of weeks?	Recruits testers for the MVP.

P1: sheet row 34

Zerodha user. Picked because an instalment failed from a mandate problem and they found out over a week later.

Rows marked “Old” came from the first question set; they cover new questions 1, 4 and 12, and part of 11. The rows after them use the new numbering.

#	Question	What they said	Their words
Old 1	Why they started	everyone telling me its a good investment, and to stop my unnecessary expenditure	
Old 2	What they expected in year one	nothing, not much gain expected	
Old 3	Setting it up	yes	
Old 4	How money moves each month	bank mandate	
Old 5	SIP date vs salary date	salary-1st day of the month, SIP date-5th of the month so that their is sufficient balance to pay for my SIP	
2	What else the money could have gone to	just wanted to try, the advertisment made me do it.	
3	When it felt real	never	
4	Salary day	pay bills, then EMIS, then SIP	
5	What gets cut first	SIP	
6	Savings or a bill	savings	
7	Last surprise	when i checked 15 months after investing, it was the same amount as initial .	
8	The day it went wrong, step by step	mandate payment got failed , i didn't got to know the same day as i was travelling where there was network , i returned in the network area after two days then saw that the payment was not carried out	
9	Who they turned to	support, to mail , not resolved	

#	Question	What they said	Their words
11 12	Mandate: bank, limit, changing bank The number in their head, and its source	ICICI Bank, 5000 limit and i dont know what will happen if I change my bank double	
13	When it's "not working"	returns	
14	The day they stopped; where the money went	not stopped	
15	Pause or reduce instead	never thought about it	
C1	Reaction: move the date	yes will move the date	
C2	Reaction: pay now or skip	skip this month	
16	Advice for a friend	selection of funds, which funds to invest in nobody told me that	
17	Open to testing a fix	yes	

P2: sheet row 27

Zerodha user. Picked because they weren't sure whether an instalment failed, named a mandate problem and found out over a week later.

#	Question	What they said	Their words
1	How they came to start	got to know from a friend, started 2018	
2	What else the money could have gone to	to stop the unnecessary expenditure	
3	When it felt real	never	
4	Salary day, in order	SIP is fixed at 5th of every month	
5	What gets cut first	never gets short of money	
6	Savings or a bill	savings	

#	Question	What they said	Their words
7	Last surprise	got good returns from one mutual fund SIP, earler invested 2000 rs now its value is 8000 rs	
8	The day it went wrong, step by step	one time my SIP failed on the due date, the day it should have been successfully executed	
9	Who they turned to	support ticket , zerodha revealed there has been a glitch lay with their payment processor, not resolved, missed the investment window.	
11	Mandate: bank, limit, changing bank	pay manually and bank mandate, changed bank, requested from zerodha App to change bank but no problem faced in changing bank	
12	The number in their head, and its source	double in 3 years	
13	When it's "not working"	less than 10 % returns	
14	The day they stopped; where the money went	if not got more than 10 % returns in one year then stopped the SIP	
15	Pause or reduce instead	never lowered only increased , never paused	
C1	Reaction: move the date	yes	
C2	Reaction: pay now or skip	pay it now	
16	Advice for a friend	direct and regular investment , go for direct because commission is cut and always go for growth, I use value research app , but not got that from zerodha	
17	Open to testing a fix	yes	

P3: sheet row 2

Zerodha user. Picked because they started recently and already had a failed instalment.

#	Question	What they said	Their words
1	How they came to start	influenced from social media , to invest and get returns from mutual funds and SIPs	
2	What else the money could have gone to	diversify the portfolio, RD and stocks , chose SIP because if it gives better returns	
3	When it felt real	initial and post COVID it felt real and i took a good decision	
4	Salary day, in order	5th of every month , auto mandate	
5	What gets cut first	will not get cut	
6	Savings or a bill	savings	
7	Last surprise	Quant tax savings mutual funds invested 20K, but now its value is 50K	
8	The day it went wrong, step by step	2024 SIP failed due to bank error , their was some issue with my debit card and i didn't got to know about that mail and 3 months SIPs was unpaid due to this	
9	Who they turned to	only visible on website not on app , used support and then resolved it	
11	Mandate: bank, limit, changing bank	bank mandate	
12	The number in their head, and its source	double	
13	When it's "not working"	expectations, kotak mutual funds went to negative in 6 months	
14	The day they stopped; where the money went	and stopped the kotak mutual fund that day, and then the money was used in the already invested mutual funds made the amount higher.	
15	Pause or reduce instead	no as trend line went much down in only 6 months	

#	Question	What they said	Their words
C1	Reaction: move the date	move the date	
C2	Reaction: pay now or skip	skip	
16	Advice for a friend	UI is a bit complex so dont suggest it to an early investor.	
17	Open to testing a fix	yes	

P4: sheet row 8

Zerodha user. Picked as the comparison: started 13–24 months ago, still running, no problems reported.

#	Question	What they said	Their words
1	How they came to start	when started earning	
2	What else the money could have gone to	use in stocks	
3	When it felt real	after 2-3 months i saw the compounding effect in unrealised PNL	
4	Salary day, in order	Auto pay set	
5	What gets cut first	expenses not SIP	
6	Savings or a bill	savings	
7	Last surprise	during trump oil crisis , market was not stable	
8	The day it went wrong, step by step	due to app problem, auto pay was not carried out	
9	Who they turned to	manually resolved it	
11	Mandate: bank, limit, changing bank	bank mandate	

#	Question	What they said	Their words
12	The number in their head, and its source	goal was closed ended fund , as risk was low and returns are more as entry and exit load are less	
13	When it's "not working"	if risk increases , will then diversify the portfolio	
14	The day they stopped; where the money went	in a different mutual fund	
15	Pause or reduce instead	never thought	
C1	Reaction: move the date	move the date	
C2	Reaction: pay now or skip	pay now	
16	Advice for a friend	go for direct plans on Coin, as expense ratio is less	
17	Open to testing a fix	yes	

P5: sheet row 5

Uses another app. Picked because they stopped their SIP after an instalment failed on a short balance.

#	Question	What they said	Their words
1	How they came to start	when i had surplus money	
2	What else the money could have gone to	would have spent it	
3	When it felt real	because of investment i was assured i could afford a career switch	
4	Salary day, in order	first pay sip manually, then pay bills	
5	What gets cut first	not cut sip	
6	Savings or a bill	savings	

#	Question	What they said	Their words
7	Last surprise	mutual fund went down due to global events and post COVID 2 years were good but not now	
8	The day it went wrong, step by step	Payment was not completed, it was still in process but was notified the payment was successful	
9	Who they turned to	support	
11	Mandate: bank, limit, changing bank	manually pay , never changed bank	
12	The number in their head, and its source	returns were good at the time i started	
13	When it's "not working"	when returns are worst than expected like my icici prudential mutual fund last year returns -were 12 % but this year returns -7%	
14	The day they stopped; where the money went	one sip- sbi automative SIP -did one time investment but not much returns were coming so i paused it	
15	Pause or reduce instead	paused it	
C1	Reaction: move the date	move the date	
C2	Reaction: pay now or skip	pay it now	
16	Advice for a friend	use only 1 platform , as its hard to maintain	
17	Open to testing a fix	yes	

P6: sheet row 13

Uses another app. Picked because they stopped their SIP, didn't know pausing existed, and weren't investing at the 1-year mark.

#	Question	What they said	Their words
1	How they came to start	when i started earning	
2	What else the money could have gone to	i would have invested them in stocks	
3	When it felt real	post COVID when the returns were high	
4	Salary day, in order	pay bills, EMIs, then SIP	
5	What gets cut first	SIP	
6	Savings or a bill	savings	
7	Last surprise	Post COVID , around 2023, one of my mutual fund SIP returns were over 12% the initial amount. Second surprise: when they started as a new user, Zerodha didn't move them to direct plans at first, first regular plans were offered. They only noticed long after. (See the note under this table.)	
8	The day it went wrong, step by step	portfolio was not updated at real time- it was stuck on yesterday's NAV , checked via different app it was different.	
9	Who they turned to	support	
11	Mandate: bank, limit, changing bank	mandate, not changed banks	
12	The number in their head, and its source	double in 2 years	
13	When it's "not working"	payments are not recovering and expectations too not met	
14	The day they stopped; where the money went	stopped as there were frequently issues going on with portfolio updates and auto pay issues	
15	Pause or reduce instead	paused one of the SIPs	

#	Question	What they said	Their words
C1	Reaction: move the date	move the date	
C2	Reaction: pay now or skip	skip	
16	Advice for a friend	use a different app for now, zerodha is a bit complex to understand at first	
17	Open to testing a fix	yes	

Note on row 7. The SEBI change runs the other way. From 1 November 2026, direct plans are the default choice on fund houses' (AMCs') own websites and apps. Regular plans stay available, with their higher expense ratio shown (Cafemutual). It was announced by the SEBI chairman on 28 October; no circular had been published by 30 October, and it doesn't cover broker apps like Coin or move anyone to regular plans (INDmoney). Coin sells direct funds with no commission (Zerodha). Regular-plan units moved into Zerodha from elsewhere stay regular; switching means redeeming them and buying the direct plan, which can be taxed (Zerodha). Open question for P6: where were the regular-plan units first bought?

Summary grid

Filled from the six interview tables. Yes or No only where the person said it; Unclear where it came up but the answer didn't settle it; a dash where the question didn't come up.

What to confirm	P1	P2	P3	P4	P5	P6	Yes count
An instalment failed at some point	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	6 of 6
Found out more than a week later	No (2 days)	Unclear	Yes (3 months)	Unclear	Unclear	Unclear	1 of 6
Recovering was hard or unclear	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	Unclear	Yes	4 of 6
A failure came before stopping or pausing	No	No	No	No	No	Yes	1 of 6
Would have kept going if fixed within a day	–	–	–	–	–	Unclear	0 of 6
Returns fell short of what they expected	Yes	No	Yes	No	Yes	Yes	4 of 6

What to confirm	P1	P2	P3	P4	P5	P6	Yes count
Stopped or paused because of returns	No	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	No	3 of 6
Knew they could pause	No	Unclear	Unclear	No	Yes	Yes	2 of 6

What the grid decides. Row 1 is Yes for all six, but row 4 is Yes for only one person: a failed payment is common, but it is rarely what makes people stop. Returns fell short for four people, three stopped or paused a SIP because of returns, and four of the six expected their money to double. By the rule set before the interviews, the returns statement now leads and failed-payment recovery becomes the supporting work. The final problem statement is in the problem definition doc.

Summary of all interviews

Six people were interviewed: four Coin users (P1 to P4) and two who use other apps (P5, P6).

- **Why they started:** others pushed them or a life moment did. P1 heard it was a good investment and saw an advert, P2 heard from a friend, P3 was influenced by social media, and P4, P5 and P6 started once they began earning or had money left over.
- **The competition:** if not a SIP, the money would have gone to stocks (P3, P4, P6), an RD (P3) or everyday spending (P2, P5).
- **How they see it:** all six call their SIP savings, not a bill. P1 and P6 pay bills and EMIs first and would cut the SIP first if money ran short; P3, P4 and P5 protect it.
- **Failures are universal and hard to see:** all six had an instalment fail or go wrong. P1 found out two days late while travelling, P3 went three months without paying because the failure showed only on the website, P5 was told a payment succeeded while it was still pending, and P6's portfolio showed yesterday's NAV.
- **Help means support, and it often doesn't fix it:** five of six went to support. P1 and P2 were not resolved, and P2 missed that month's investment; P4 fixed it manually.
- **Expectations are high:** P1, P2, P3 and P6 expected money to double, P2 and P6 within two to three years. P1 saw the same amount after 15 months; P3 and P5 saw funds go negative.
- **Why people stopped:** three of the four stops were about returns. P2 stops a SIP that hasn't made 10% in a year, P3 stopped a fund that went negative in six months, and P5 paused one that wasn't giving returns. Only P6 stopped because of payments, after repeated autopay and portfolio-update problems.
- **Pausing is barely known:** P1 and P4 never thought of pausing or lowering; only P5 and P6 had used pause.

- **Reactions to rough ideas:** all six would move the SIP date to after salary day (C1). After a failure (C2), three would pay now (P2, P4, P5) and three would skip the month (P1, P3, P6).
- **Advice for a friend:** choose direct plans (P2, P4), get help choosing funds (P1), keep to one platform (P5), and expect a complex app at first (P3, P6).
- **Next step:** all six agreed to test an early fix.